PalmSource™ 99

Introducing a Product to Market

Panel Moderator:
Jane Ann Day, Market Development Manager

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Agenda

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- Introduction
- Panelist presentations
- Q&A

Introducing Our Panelists…

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- Ken Landau, LandWare, Inc.
- C.E. Steuart Dewar, Pimlico Software, Inc.
- Brian Hall, Mark/Space Softworks


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Ken Landau
LandWare, Inc.
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About LandWare

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- Started 1996, focus on handheld software Newton, WinCE, Palm
- Commercial Solutions
- Current solutions: GoType!, goVox, Pocket Quicken, Zagat Survey, Gulliver
- Based in New Jersey, privately held
- Focus on quality products, customer support and extensive product distribution

Why We Entered the Palm Market

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Key factors in the decision

- Market share and potential market growth
- Competitive Landscape
- Distribution options in place
- Partnerships available
- 3Com support
- Our own personal use

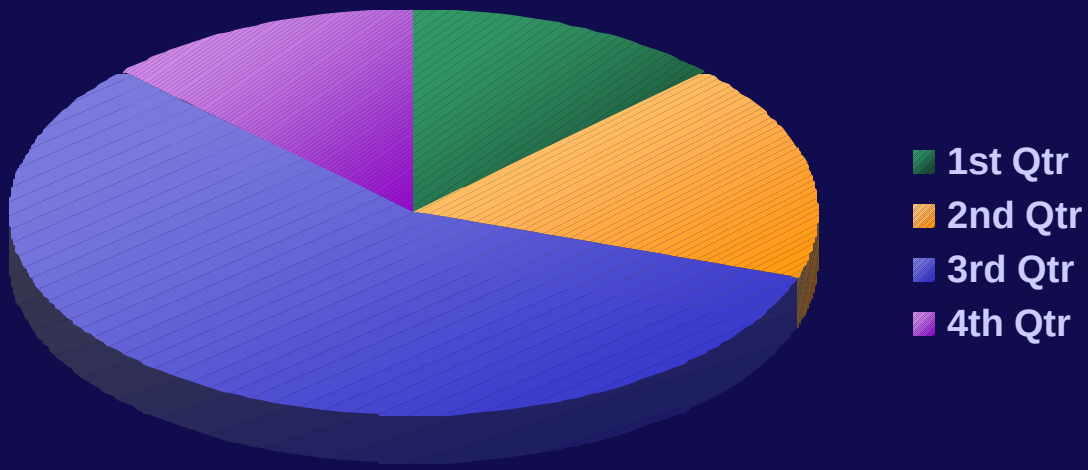
Our Plan

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- Stay focused. LandWare's focus =
  - Commercial "shrink-wrap" solutions
  - Business productivity
- Offer strong Support
  - Phone, e-mail, web
- Maximize distribution options
  - Web, direct, retail, mail order, partnering

The Market

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A Challenge—Getting the Word Out

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- First Steps
  - Thank the beta testers (‘Evangelists’), send a copy
  - Web page
  - Newsgroups
  - PalmGear, PalmCentral
  - Newswire
  - User Group contacts
  - TAP, Pen Computing, also solution related print
  - Software Solutions Guide Ad
  - Contact distributors/resellers
  - Palm Contacts
  - OEM Contacts

Market Challenge

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- "The Palm Organizer has everything I need."
  - Address book, Date book, to do list, calc…
- Answer, yes but…
  - You can do more!
    - Track expenses, language translation
    - Take meeting notes, even—play games
- Use all means to open Palm community to going beyond the built-in core
  - Make free demos available—web, beam, ftp, AOL
  - Beam them
  - Evangelize the platform

Resources

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- Jane's List
- Web
- User Groups

- Networking at Palm Source!


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C. E. Steuart Dewar
President, Pimlico Software, Inc.
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Introducing a Product to Market

What is Pimlico Software?

- PDA Software distributed as shareware
  - DateBk3, WeekView
- Not your “average” company ;)
- All revenues are donated for Wildlife Conservation and www.gorilla-haven.org
- Lower overhead costs a priority



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Key Success Factors

- Identify and exploit your competitive edge
- Provide the service YOU would want as a customer
- The “30-second experience”
- Leverage the platform:
  - Consistent look and feel
  - Let your customers promote sales
- Leverage the Internet
  - Sell GLOBALLY
  - Do everything electronically



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Useful Resources

- Internet
  - Registration services
  - News Groups
- Palm Computing developer resources
  - Outstanding commitment to provide assistance
  - Developers Forum Lists
- Palm Computing® Platform web sites



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Brian Hall, President/CEO
Mark/Space Softworks



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About Mark/Space

- Founded October 31, 1990 (spooky!)
- Develop for most platforms
  - Mac, Windows and Palm Computing Platform
  - Software for several SpringBoard™ Modules
  - Did Newton apps in a former life
- We make communications software
  - PageNOW!—1 and 2 way Paging/SMS
  - Online—Terminal Emulation
  - PhoneWatcher—Caller ID/Call Tracking
- Came from Commercial/Shrink-wrap background

Why Join the Palm Economy?

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- Rapidly expanding user base
- Excellent market share
- Relatively few points of contact for PR, advertising, and distribution
  - Use that to your advantage—you can actually get to personally know everyone you need to know
  - This is not true in the desktop/webtop markets
- Lower development and marketing costs
- Enjoyment/Lifestyle

Why Not CE?

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- Market Size
  - The café/airport/bar test
- Development Environments
  - Any color as long as its black!
- Deployment/Testing
  - Multiple CPUs to target for and test against
- We will do it when it makes business sense

Things to Watch Out For

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- Price sensitivity
  - Most shareware apps sell for under $20
  - Few commercial apps sell for over $30
- Ways to address price issues
  - Develop many smaller apps instead of fewer/larger ones
  - Seek out ways to OEM/License/Private Label your software

Cut Your Costs!

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- Sell “Online” versions only, or as an option
- Offer support via e-mail/web rather than telephone
- Require HotSync® name for unlock key—reduce “sharing”
  - Amazing how when you do this, suddenly large companies actually need more than 1 copy!
  - Imagine that!

Ways to Market Your Apps

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- PR
  - Magazines—TAP, PC Week
  - Online—Pilot PDA mailing list, IRC, Newsgroups
- Advertising
  - Banner Ads—PGHQ, PalmCentral
  - Print—Tap Magazine, In-Box Catalog
- Your Own Customer List
- Cross-Market with your Partners
- Get Platinum Certified

Ways to Distribute Your Apps

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- Online/Web
- PGHQ
- Beaming
  - Word-of-mouth factor
- Retail? Getting there

Creative Ways to Increase Revenue

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- Create an API/Standard
  - If your app has an API or supports plug-ins, every company that supports it becomes a sales force for your own product
  - Examples: Screen Savers, “Doc”, HackMaster™, etc.
- Private Label/Custom Versions

Resources/Networking

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- Technical
  - Palm OS Developer mailing list
  - massena newsgroups
- Marketing
  - Center for Software Development
  - PalmOS Entrepreneurs Forum
    - Mailing List—www.markspace.com/pef/
    - Periodic FTF gatherings

Conclusions

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- You can succeed in the Palm Economy
- Use the differences of the Palm Computing® Platform to your advantage
- Be creative
- Join us on PEF-Talk!


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